MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LEATHER, CATTLEHIDE, RAWHIDE, HARD

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for hard rawhide sides from cattlehide (see 6.1).

* 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

KK-L-311 - Leather; Methods of Sampling and Testing.

MILITARY

MIL-L-43432 - Leather, Packaging and Packing Of.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.- The rawhide shall be firm, top grain, untanned cattlehide and shall be free from offensive odor. No oils, greases, solvents, resins, fillers, or other additives shall be introduced into the rawhide. The grain side shall be clean and free from hair and scud. The flesh side shall be smooth and free from loose flesh. Bullhides shall not be used.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Physical requirements:

3.2.1 Trim (form and area).- The rawhide shall be furnished in the form of sides and shall conform with the definition of sides as listed under "Definition of Terms" in KK-L-311. The area of the side shall be not less than 18 square feet nor greater than 28 square feet. The area expressed in terms of square feet shall be legibly marked in the butt area on the flesh side of each side.

3.2.2 Thickness.- The thickness of the rawhide shall be not less than 6 ounces nor greater than 8 ounces. Note: 1 ounce = 1/64 inch.

3.2.3 Color.- The color of the rawhide shall be natural. No coloring agents shall be used.

3.3 Finish.- No finish shall be applied to the rawhide.

3.4 Workmanship.- The finished rawhide shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Certificate of compliance.- Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

* 4.2.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 4.2.2 Examination of the end item.- The classification of defects found during the examination shall be in accordance with the lists shown in 4.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one side. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one side. Sampling for these examinations shall be performed in accordance with KK-L-311 except that a sample size of 15 and a rejection number of 2 shall be applicable for thickness determinations on lots consisting of 91 or more sides.

4.2.2.1 Examination for visual characteristics.-

Examine	Defect
Material	Not top grain. Not rawhide. Not free of offensive odor. Evidence of additives. Tacky surface. Any stain. Grain not clean or not free of hair and scud. Flesh side not smooth or not free of loose flesh.
Trim	Not as specified.
Color	Not as specified.
Finish	Application of finish on rawhide.
Quality of rawhide	Any hole, cut, open scratch, brand, hip mark, rough shoulder, deep fat wrinkle, heavy vein or other defects which impair the cutting value of more than 12 percent of the total area of the side.

NOTE: Light, well healed scratches and grub scars, light fat wrinkles and slight stains shall not be classified as defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 4.2.2.2 Examination for dimensional characteristics.-

Examine	Defect
Area (expressed in terms of square feet)	Less than area marked on side. Less than 18 square feet. Greater than 28 square feet.
Marking	Omitted, illegible, or not in area specified.
Thickness 1/	Not as specified.

1/ Thickness shall be measured in accordance with Method 1011 of KK-L-311.

* 4.2.3 Certification.- The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance indicating that the rawhide specified in 3.1 has been made from cattlehide and that no additives have been introduced into the rawhide.

* 4.2.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made in accordance with the provisions of MIL-L-43432 to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with.

* 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

* 5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Levels A and C.- Leather shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-L-43432.

* 5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Levels A, B, and C.- Leather shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-L-43432.

* 5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-43432.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The rawhide covered by this specification is intended for use in sewing palms.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a.) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b.) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

* 6.3 Marginal code identification.- The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done only as a convenience and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 11

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - SA
Air Force - 82, 85

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8330-0075

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION
Leather, Cattlehide, Rawhide, Hard MIL-L-1978B

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 68 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T13:55Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.